

The 6:15

MONDAY · AUGUST 24, 2026

NO. 6

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Mon 8/24	Bessent presser detailing Trump's "Economic D-Day" Iran sanctions, 2:00p ET — secondary sanctions on oil buyers, banks, shipping reportedly in scope.
Tue 8/25	Intuit, Dick's Sporting Goods earnings (consensus not verified this run).
Wed 8/26	Nvidia aft. close (cons. rev. \$91.85B, EPS \$2.08); Salesforce, CrowdStrike aft. close; July PCE + Q2 GDP 2nd est. + durable goods, 8:30a (BEA); Lisa Cook's deadline to respond to removal letter.
Thu 8/27–Fri 8/28	Marvell aft. close, jobless claims; Jackson Hole opens (thru 8/29); Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, Fri 10:00a ET.
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision.

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic reportedly targeting an Oct. 26 Nasdaq pricing, ~\$2T valuation (**reported, not company-confirmed**); Microsoft reportedly in talks for 300,000+ TSMC Maia 300 units, reveal as soon as Sept. (**single original source, unconfirmed**). No primary, rocket launch, or frontier AI release verified this window — a prior issue's "Oregon primary 8/25" does not check out against Oregon's official calendar (primary was 5/19) and is dropped.

METRICS — ~6:20A ET MON 8/24

Oil	ICE Brent settled Fri 8/21 \$94.39 (+0.65%); down to \$93.09 (−1.38%) Mon AM ahead of sanctions. WTI \$85.65 (−1.62%) vs. \$85.36 (unreconciled). Spread ~\$7.44–8.74.
Rates & FX	UST 2y/10y/30y: 4.24% / 4.71% / 5.24% (Mon composite, not single-sourced). DXY 98.99 (+0.19%). VIX last confirmed 14.2 (Fri close, 2026 low) (no fresher print located).
Equities	S&P futures −0.11% to −0.2%; Nasdaq futures −0.35% to −0.7% (range, Mon premarket). Nikkei 65,528 (Mon, −0.7%; chip names led decliners). Hang Seng/Europe: not confirmed this run.

Other Gold \$4,645.74 spot (Mon, +0.83%) — highest since mid-May. Retail gas \$4.10/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/20) — highest ever for that date.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 176 (global-energy-flow.com); straits.live had Day 175 as of 8/22 — different start-date conventions, not reconciled
Transits	7 vessels Thu 8/21 (4 in/3 out, no VLCC/LNG; 1 VLGC via Iranian route — Kpler daily). Lloyd's List's latest published weekly figure still 73 for 8/10–16 (vs. 91 prior wk) — no fresher weekly count published
Seizure	Tanker Amara remains held stationary near Qeshm Island, seized 8/17 — no resumed movement
Strikes, 24h	None confirmed; last confirmed strike remains Minoan Dignity, 8/17–18 (fatal)
War-risk premium	7.5–10% of hull value fleet-wide, late July (Marsh/S&P Global) (no fresher figure, stale)
Dark tankers	not confirmed as of press time — no current-week figure located this run

Kpler publishes near-real-time AIS-visible daily transit counts; Lloyd's List Intelligence aggregates weekly commercial transits >10,000 dwt with Iran-link attribution, preliminary/revised; straits.live and similar trackers run independent day-counts and broker-sourced premium quotes on their own schedules. Report side by side — never net or average.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Toronto 8-3 Sun 8/23 (Ben Rice 2-run single, 3-run 6th). 74-55, 2nd AL East.
Knicks	No signed moves; Hart extension (eligible since 8/10) still unsigned, reported terms unchanged (3-yr/\$60–62M).
Northwestern	Uihlein family committed \$35M/3-yr to football program (announced 8/11) — not previously logged.

LEAD

SANCTIONS · OIL

Bessent's "Economic D-Day" lands this afternoon — and oil is selling off, not pricing in, ahead of it.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent holds a press conference at 2 p.m. ET today to detail what the administration has branded “Economic D-Day” — a package he’s told CNBC will be “the single greatest financial offensive ever” against Iran and what he’s called the “endgame” of Washington’s pressure campaign. The reported design is a “one-two punch”: the existing naval blockade of Iranian ports paired with what Bessent is calling the “toughest sanctions in history,” centered on secondary sanctions against countries and entities that keep buying Iranian oil, process its financing, operate related banks, or support its shipping networks. It would layer onto an already extensive regime covering Iran’s banking, energy, aviation and cryptocurrency sectors. Bessent has also urged China specifically to cooperate — the clearest signal yet that Beijing’s continued purchases of discounted Iranian crude are a named target, not a background irritant.

Iran’s response arrived before the podium did. Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei called the coming measures “far more than continued unlawful ‘economic warfare’ against a single country,” while state media framed the campaign as an “implicit admission of the enemy’s humiliating defeat.” More concretely: Tehran is warning it will seize vessels that violate its new transit and toll rules in the strait, and is separately warning Gulf neighbors against joining the U.S. measures — a direct shot at a UAE that has already cut all economic and financial ties with Tehran (announced 8/19, after Iran allegedly fired ballistic missiles at Emirati territory, which Iran denies). *(Read: warning Gulf states off cooperation, days after the UAE already defected commercially, reads as Tehran trying to stop a second domino before it falls, not confidence that the first one can be reversed.)*

The market reaction is the actual news here, because it cuts against the obvious script. Brent, which settled Friday at \$94.39 on a run-up that had already priced roughly a week of escalation, is down 1.38% to \$93.09 this morning; WTI is off a similar 1.6% to the mid-\$85s. A toughest-ever sanctions package aimed at a chokepoint already running at a fraction of normal volume would, mechanically, be expected to support crude — yet the session is selling off into the announcement. *(Read: two readings compete. One is straightforward profit-taking after last week's roughly \$5, 6% spike already discounted a hard line from Washington. The other is more pointed skepticism: after five months of blockade and threat that have visibly failed to reopen the strait or meaningfully cut the volume of Iranian crude finding buyers through intermediaries, traders may simply be discounting Bessent's "toughest ever" framing as rhetoric that has been heard before, several times, from this same podium.)* Either reading matters for the rest of the week — if Bessent's specifics disappoint relative to the rhetoric, oil's pre-emptive fade will look prescient; if the secondary-sanctions list actually reaches large-volume buyers like Chinese refiners, the move could reverse hard and fast.

That tension sits inside a broader market already nervous about U.S. fiscal credibility for reasons that have nothing to do with Iran. Gold extended its rally to \$4,645.74 Monday, a fresh high since mid-May, on the same Treasury bond-buyback surprise that pushed yields and the dollar down last week — a signal that some of the flight-to-safety bid this month is about Washington's own balance sheet, not just the Gulf. The 10-year sits at 4.71%, still elevated enough that a supply shock from Bessent's own sanctions regime would land on top of, not instead of, an already-jittery rates market. Equity futures

are shrugging for now — S&P and Nasdaq futures both modestly lower, unremarkable by the standard of a market that's absorbed worse this month — but the setup into a week that also carries Nvidia's earnings, the PCE/GDP cluster, and Jackson Hole leaves little room for the sanctions rollout to be a non-event if it disappoints in either direction.

POLITICS

Fed Governor Lisa Cook's deadline to respond to Trump's renewed removal effort is now two days out, landing Wednesday alongside Nvidia's earnings and the PCE/GDP data cluster — the same collision flagged in the last issue, now imminent rather than abstract. (*Developing.*) No new filing or statement from Cook's attorneys, Abbe Lowell and Norm Eisen, has surfaced since their prior characterization of the mortgage-fraud allegations as "baseless." The House-Senate funding gap (Senate CR to Dec. 11, House's own version only to Dec. 4) remains unresolved with the House still in recess — unchanged since the last issue.

ECONOMICS

Rate-path odds moved against the hawkish read the July minutes produced last issue: CME FedWatch showed September-hike probability at roughly 30% as of 8/20, with a hold near 68.4% — down from the "very much in play" framing right after the minutes, as softer retail sales, a cooling labor market and easing inflation prints reassert themselves in the pricing. No rate cut is meaningfully priced for September. That backdrop makes Wednesday's cluster — July PCE, the Q2 GDP second estimate, durable goods — the next real test of which read holds, arriving hours before Nvidia's earnings

and Cook's removal-response deadline. Goldman Sachs has separately cautioned against pressing hawkish bets into that data, per reporting this run. **(Single-sourced characterization.)**

BUSINESS

Anthropic's IPO preparations sharpened this run: Q2 revenue reportedly hit \$11.5B against \$787M a year earlier, with the annualized run rate reaching \$65B by the end of July and one forecast projecting ARR near \$140B by May 2027 (Claude Code alone contributing an estimated \$23.5B of that). Press reporting now attaches a specific pricing target — Oct. 26, on Nasdaq, led by Goldman Sachs, JPMorgan and Morgan Stanley — against a reported ~\$2 trillion valuation target, roughly double the \$965B mark set in May's private round. **(Valuation and date are reported, not confirmed by the company.)** The filing is expected to list AI-sector backlash as a named risk factor. Ahead of Wednesday's print, Nvidia consensus sits at \$91.85B revenue and \$2.08 EPS for the July quarter, essentially in line with the company's own \$91.0B guide (plus or minus 2%) — a low bar by the standard of recent quarters, which is itself being read as the setup for a large move either way. *(Read.)*

TECHNOLOGY

Microsoft's push for its own Maia 300 AI accelerator has more outlets now citing a September reveal target and talks with TSMC for capacity north of 300,000 units for 2027 delivery, with an eventual goal above 1 million units. *(Developing.)* The reporting still traces to a single original source (The Information) now republished widely — an upgrade in distribution, not in independent

confirmation — and neither Microsoft nor TSMC has put a number on the record. No new frontier-model release or Gemini 3.5 Pro date surfaced this run.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia and Ukraine continued overnight exchanges: Ukrainian forces struck a radar station and a site used to store and launch unmanned surface vessels in occupied Crimea, per Ukrainian reporting. (*Developing.*) Xi Jinping's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with export controls the unresolved friction point; no new developments surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the sanctions rollout covered in the Lead, the operational picture is largely a holding pattern at a severe level: the seized tanker Amara remains stationary near Qeshm Island more than a week after its detention, with no reported release or further Iranian action against it. (*Developing.*) Transit data continues to show the strait running far below any pre-crisis baseline — Thursday's 7-vessel Kpler count and the still-current 73-transit weekly figure from Lloyd's List both predate today's sanctions announcement, so neither yet reflects what may be the more consequential variable this week: whether Tehran responds to "Economic D-Day" with new seizures or strikes rather than just rhetoric. The UAE's trade suspension, announced 8/19, is reported to be moving from announcement to phased implementation — initial restrictions on cargo and financial flows — a data point to confirm in the next 24–48 hours rather than treat as settled today. **(Implementation status not independently verified this run.)**

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Toronto 8-3 Sun 8/23 (Ben Rice 2-run single, 3-run 6th). 74-55, 2nd AL East.
Knicks	Off-season, no game. Josh Hart extension talks ongoing (see Transactions) — still unsigned.
Northwestern	Off-season; \$35M Uihlein-family football commitment announced 8/11 (see Transactions). Opener remains Sat 9/5, 7:00p CT vs. South Dakota State.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 8/23: House-Senate funding gap detail, cumulative Hormuz strike count (still unreconciled), FOMC July minutes detail (fully reported last issue). Corrected: dropped an “Oregon primary Tue 8/25” calendar item carried in the prior issue that does not check out against Oregon’s official 2026 election calendar (primary was 5/19).

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.